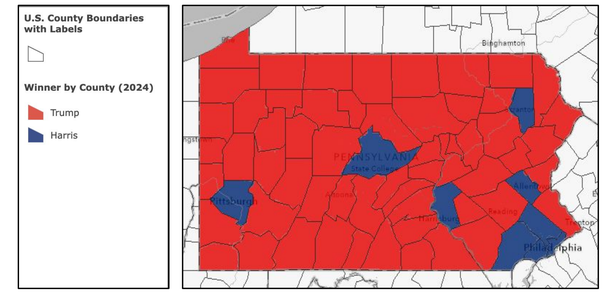
The Plight of Pennsylvania's Palette: Will PA be Red or Blue and Other Questions About the 2024 Election

Noah Thomas, Ryan Carson

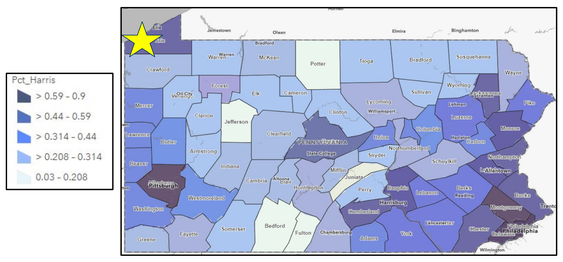
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Preface

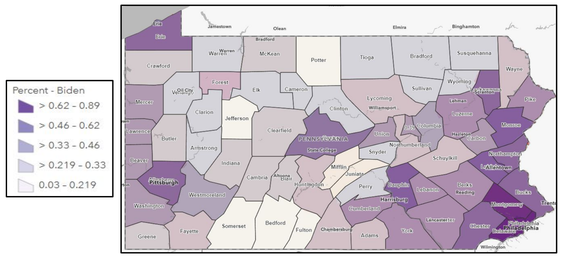
Pennsylvania has always been an important state in national elections. In the words of Christopher Borick and Rafael Jacob, "If Pennsylvania has moved, it has moved, almost always, in a rhythm very close to America's as a whole." Throughout history, Pennsylvania was known as a swing state. Only in recent decades has it become primarily Democratic. For example, John F Kennedy won by less than 1% in 1960, and in 2020 Biden got 50.01% of the vote. However, Donald Trump has undoubtedly revived Republican support in the state, inverting previous Democratic coalitions and getting the state to turn red in 2016 and 2024. With Trump's win, what conclusions can we draw from of voters and the election?



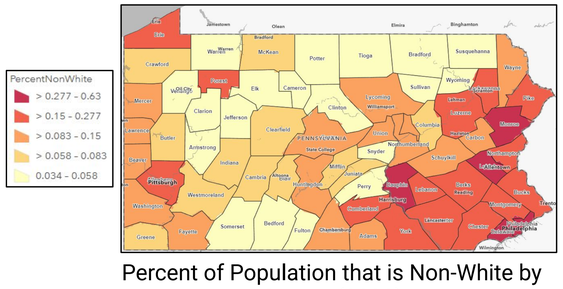
Democrats Between Elections



Percent of Vote for Kamala Harris by County (2024)



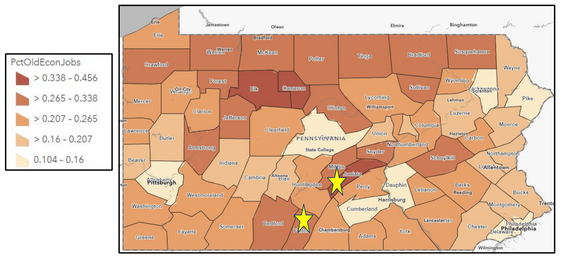
Percent of Vote for Joe Biden by County (2020)



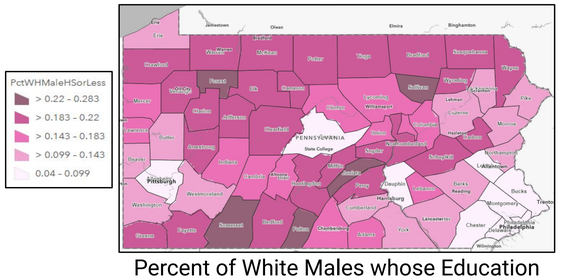
Percent of Population that is Non-White by County (2023)

- In 2024, Harris got fewer votes than Biden in 2020
- Led some counties such as Erie (starred) to flip. The county voted red in 2016, blue in 2020, and red again in 2024
- Despite being a woman and biracial Harris did not earn a significant amount of votes from these demographics
- This is due to lack of focus on central issues such as the economy and minority races questioning if she would truly represent them
- Pennsylvania's Hispanic population has been trending right

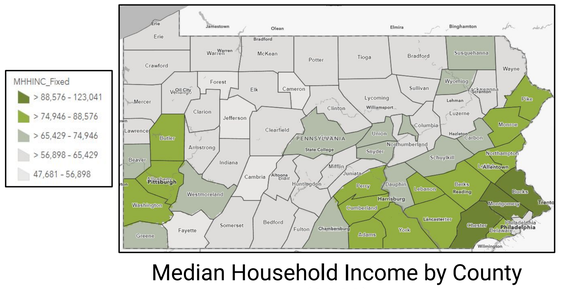
Economic Factors



Percent of Population with Old Economy Jobs by County (2023)



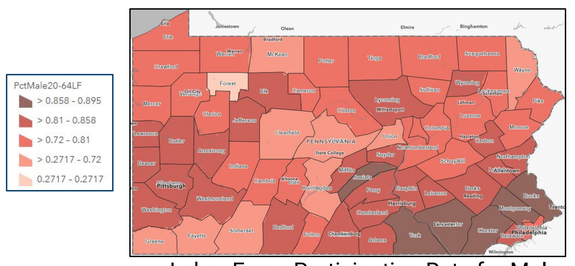
Percent of White Males whose Education Level is High School or Less by County (2023)



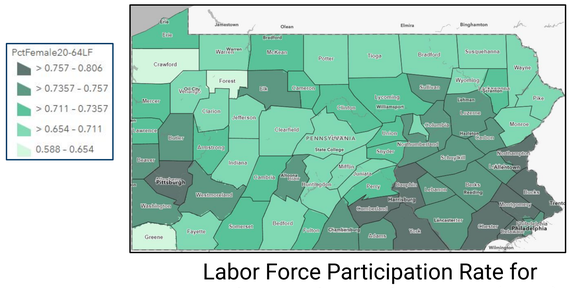
Median Household Income by County (2023)

- All counties with high percentage of old economy jobs voted for Trump
- Juniata and Fulton counties (starred) among highest in Trump support and old-economy jobs
- Strong inverse relationship between percent of white persons with high school education or lower and median household income
- All of less-wealthy (and lower educated) counties voted for Trump from 2016-2024
- Weak relationship between Democratic support and county wealth

Gender and Workforce



Labor Force Participation Rate for Males Aged 20-64 by County (2023)



Labor Force Participation Rate for Females Aged 20-64 by County (2023)

- Strong relationship between high female Labor Force participation rate and polarization of a county (strongest Democrat and Republican counties have high rates)
- For males, higher rate generally relates to more Democratic support

Conclusion

As long as the Democrats fail to strengthen their appeal to women and minority populations in Pennsylvania, the Republicans are likely to continue security victories by leveraging support in economically struggling counties.

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3. United States Census Bureau
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